

Guardian Group Compliance Portal

Full Cost Projection — Portal, App & AI Layer

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Overview

Full monthly cost picture across four growth stages: server infrastructure, Replit platform (seats, Agent & deployment), the Guardian mobile app (core infrastructure for consultant site inspections), in-house team employment, and an optional AI layer. All costs shown per stage so budget can be planned incrementally.

Important: the development team and Replit Agent costs (Sections 2 & 3) cover all coding work — both the web portal and the Guardian mobile app. Section 4 covers app platform fees only (App Store, build pipeline). There is no separate “app dev cost” on top.

Assumptions: 5 client users/company; 100 consultants + 200 admin (fixed); 3 sites/company; 20 docs/site/year. App: 50–100 consultants using it monthly for on-site inspections. Current team: 1 PT developer.

Scale Reference

Stage	Companies	Client Users	Total Users	Sites	Docs/year
Stage 1	100	500	800	300	6,000
Stage 2	1,000	5,000	5,300	3,000	60,000
Stage 3	5,000	25,000	25,300	15,000	300,000
Stage 4	10,000	50,000	50,300	30,000	600,000

1. Server & Infrastructure

Covers the server, database, and file storage for the portal and app. Mobile app traffic from 50–100 consultants is served by the same backend — no separate infrastructure required.

Stage	Companies	Server	Database	Storage	Total/mo
Stage 1	100	£50–110	£30–50	£5	£85–165
Stage 2	1,000	£200–360	£100–180	£20–35	£320–575
Stage 3	5,000	£820–1,450	£350–700	£80–150	£1,250–2,300
Stage 4	10,000	£2,050–3,550	£700–1,400	£150–280	£2,900–5,230

2. Replit Platform — Seats, Agent & Deployment

Agent costs cover both portal and app development.

Replit Agent is used for all code — whether that is a new portal feature or a new screen in the Guardian mobile app. The figures below reflect total coding activity across both products. There is no separate Agent budget needed for the app.

Developer seats (~£20–30/person/month)

Each developer needs a Replit Core or Teams subscription. Seat count grows with the team.

Replit Agent (AI-assisted coding) — real-world spend

Replit Agent is billed on usage and scales with how actively the team is building. Real-world experience on this project shows Agent spend exceeding £500/month during active build sprints. This is a sprint cost — it drops sharply during maintenance-only periods.

- Maintenance-only months (bug fixes, minor tweaks): £50–150/month

- Regular feature work (weekly releases): £200–400/month
- Active build sprints (current real-world level): £400–700/month
- Multiple developers, heavy parallel builds: £600–1,200/month

Replit deployment

Stages 1–2: Replit hosts the application. Stages 3–4: migrates to dedicated cloud (GCP/AWS); Replit becomes dev-environment only.

Stage	Companies	Seats	Agent (realistic)	Deployment	Replit Total/mo
Stage 1	100	£20–30 (1 dev)	£200–700 (sprint-dependent)	£15–30	£235–760
Stage 2	1,000	£40–60 (2 devs)	£400–1,200 (2 devs building)	£30–60	£470–1,320
Stage 3	5,000	£80–120 (3–4 devs)	£600–1,500 (larger team)	Migrated to cloud	£680–1,620
Stage 4	10,000	£100–150 (4–5 devs)	£700–1,800 (mature platform)	Migrated to cloud	£800–1,950

Budget Replit Agent as a sprint cost, not a fixed monthly overhead.

Plan for £400–700/month during active build periods (current level) and £50–150 in quieter months. For annual budgeting, a blended estimate of £300–500/month is realistic. These figures cover all development — portal and app combined.

3. In-House Development Team

Team costs cover all development work — portal and app combined.

The developers shown below are responsible for both the web portal and the Guardian mobile app. From Stage 2, one developer can own the portal and one the app. There is no separate “app developer” cost on top of these figures — until Stage 3–4 where a dedicated mobile specialist becomes advisable (see note below).

Employment cost = gross salary x ~1.30 (employer NI ~13.8% + pension ~5% + equipment ~10%). UK 2026 benchmarks: PT £22k–28k | Junior FT £28k–36k | Mid FT £42k–55k | Senior FT £62k–80k.

Stage	Team Composition	Gross Salaries/yr	Employment Cost/mo
Stage 1	1x PT Developer (portal + app)	~£22k–28k	~£2,400–3,000
Stage 2	2x FT Mid Developers (1x portal, 1x app)	~£84k–110k	~£9,100–11,900
Stage 3	1x Senior + 2x Mid + 1x Junior (all products)	~£174k–226k	~£18,850–24,450
Stage 4	2x Senior + 2x Mid + 2x Junior (all products)	~£260k–322k	~£28,200–34,900

Stage 3–4: consider adding a dedicated mobile developer.

As the Guardian app grows in complexity — more inspection types, offline mode, richer reporting — a dedicated mobile specialist becomes advisable. This would be an additional hire: ~£42k–55k gross/year (£4,550–5,950/month employment cost). This is not included in the team figures above and should be budgeted separately when the app roadmap justifies it.

4. Guardian Mobile App — Platform Fees Only

This section covers platform fees only — not development labour.

App development time is already included in the team (Section 3) and Replit Agent (Section 2) costs. The figures below are the fixed platform costs that exist regardless of how much development work is done: App Store fees and the Expo build pipeline.

Consultants (50–100 users) use the app on-site to conduct H&S inspections, record findings, photograph hazards, and manage compliance actions in real time. The app connects to the same backend as the web portal — no additional server cost.

- Apple Developer Programme: £79/year (~£7/month). Google Play: £20 one-off.
- Expo EAS build pipeline: free at Stage 1, £25–99/month at Stages 2–4 for production-grade automated builds and push

notifications.

Stage	Consultant Users	Expo EAS Build Pipeline	App Store/mo	Platform Total/mo
Stage 1	50–100	Free tier	£7	£7–15
Stage 2	50–100+	£25–60/mo	£7	£32–67
Stage 3	50–100+	£60–99/mo	£7	£67–106
Stage 4	50–100+	£99/mo	£7	£106–120

5. AI Layer (Optional Enhancement)

Adding AI features (document analysis, risk scoring, chatbot, automated inspection report drafting) introduces API costs that scale with usage. AI providers charge per token; one interaction typically uses 1,000–5,000 tokens.

Stage	Companies	Light (tagging, summaries)	Medium (chatbot, risk scoring)	Heavy (full AI assistant)
Stage 1	100	£20–50	£60–200	£200–600
Stage 2	1,000	£50–150	£200–600	£600–2,000
Stage 3	5,000	£150–500	£600–2,500	£2,500–8,000
Stage 4	10,000	£400–1,000	£1,500–6,000	£6,000–20,000

Recommendation: start at Light, move to Medium when the value is proven.

A lighter model (GPT-4o Mini) handles tagging and summaries for under £50/month at Stage 1. Factor Medium or Heavy AI costs into client pricing before enabling those features at scale.

Full Monthly Cost Summary — All Stages

Core Total = infrastructure + Replit (blended: seats + Agent) + team employment + app platform fees. All development labour (portal and app) is already captured in Replit and team. AI is additional and optional. A dedicated mobile developer at Stage 3–4 would add ~£4,550–5,950/month if required.

Stage	Infrastructure	Replit (blended)	Team	App (platform)	Core Total/mo
Stage 1 (100 cos.)	£85–165	£300–500	£2,400–3,000	£7–15	£2,792–3,680
Stage 2 (1,000 cos.)	£320–575	£600–1,200	£9,100–11,900	£32–67	£10,052–13,742
Stage 3 (5,000 cos.)	£1,250–2,300	£800–1,500	£18,850–24,450	£67–106	£20,967–28,356
Stage 4 (10,000 cos.)	£2,900–5,230	£1,000–1,800	£28,200–34,900	£106–120	£32,206–42,050

Add AI on top depending on which features are enabled:

Stage 1: +£20–600 | Stage 2: +£50–2,000 | Stage 3: +£150–8,000 | Stage 4: +£400–20,000

Key Takeaways

App dev costs are inside Sections 2 and 3 — not additional

- Team employment (Section 3) covers all development: portal, app, and infrastructure
- Replit Agent costs (Section 2) cover all coding activity across both products
- Section 4 is platform fees only (App Store + build pipeline: £7–120/month)
- A dedicated mobile developer at Stage 3–4 is the one potential additional cost (~£4,550–5,950/month)

Team is the dominant cost at every stage

- 2x FT developers from Stage 2: one owns portal, one owns app — no additional hire needed at Stage 1–2
- Team ramp: 1 PT !' 2 FT !' 4 FT !' 6 FT — proportionate to company count growth

Replit Agent: budget for sprint-level spend

- Real-world spend is currently >£500/month during active build phases — this is expected and covers all work
- Blended annual estimate: £300–500/month; drops to £50–150 during maintenance-only months

AI is optional and stage-variable

- Start light at Stage 1 (<£50/month); factor heavier AI into client pricing at Stage 3–4

Summary

Stage 1 (100 companies, 1x PT dev):

~£2,792–3,680/month core (+£20–600 if AI added)

Stage 2 (1,000 companies, 2x FT devs):

~£10,052–13,742/month core (+£50–2,000 if AI added)

Stage 3 (5,000 companies, 4x FT devs):

~£20,967–28,356/month core (+£150–8,000 if AI added, +£4,550–5,950 if dedicated mobile dev added)

Stage 4 (10,000 companies, 6x FT devs):

~£32,206–42,050/month core (+£400–20,000 if AI added, +£4,550–5,950 if dedicated mobile dev added)

All app development labour is included in the team and Replit Agent costs. Section 4 (app) covers platform fees only. Replit Agent is currently running at >£500/month in active development — this is normal and covers all coding across both products.

Disclaimer: Indicative estimates based on mid-2026 pricing. UK salary benchmarks. AI costs based on current OpenAI/Anthropic API pricing. Infrastructure based on cloud provider list rates. Actual costs will vary.

